viewed nature as well as the non-Christian New World through its Cartesian dualist/humanist prism; and

2. This dualist approach gave birth to the European coloniser's sense of superiority over the rest of nature, including non-Christian idolatrous and nature-worshipping indigenous peoples. It led to the reshaping of nature to suit the material goals of the European coloniser, thereby giving rise to modern notions of development, and his sense of anthropological superiority created a race consciousness that spawned the global imperial exercise to civilise the soulless heathen natives by replacing the entirety of their cultures with the European's. The cumulative effect was a colonial remapping of geographies/boundaries and a distinctly religion-inspired, race-driven reallocation of labour and resources, culminating in the creation of the modern economy as well as its political institutions.

Naturally, the political, religious, legal and educational infrastructure set up by the coloniser was geared towards meeting the end goals of the said global project. However, the extent of investment and settlement in indigenous lands by the European coloniser depended on the opportunity they represented and their hospitability, both physical and social. According to Patrick Ziltener, where conditions were conducive for settlement, including for political consolidation, it led to settler colonialism, and therefore greater institutional investment in the colonised society.[1] For instance, after setting up the administrative and legal apparatus which ensured that the reins of the colonised society were firmly in the hands of the coloniser, educational institutions were established primarily in those colonies where the coloniser settled.[2] In contrast, in those lands which were not conducive for settlement but were rich in resources, institutions that facilitated the process of rent-seeking and expropriation of resources through the purchased or coerced aid of local rulers were set up.

Importantly, the manner in which natives were recruited into the colonial power structure was yet another proof of the European coloniser's deeply ingrained ethno-religious consciousness. Soldiers and mercenaries were recruited from those sections of the native society that were identified as 'martial races', which was developed into a full-fledged doctrine and also applied in India.[3] The British Indian army was organised on religious and caste lines, again pointing to the coloniser's racial approach not just to